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一、中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文反驳了“正规教育应成为贫困国家推动经济快速发展的首要优先事项”这一传统主流观点，指出正规教育与经济增长的关系被经济学家和政治家普遍误解。文章通过美国汽车工人和墨西哥建筑工人的实例，证明在岗培训能大幅提升劳动力生产力；进而提出核心论点：**经济增长实际上会推动教育发展，而非相反**；缺乏正规教育并不会限制发展中国家劳动力在可预见未来大幅提升生产力，反而是生产力提升的瓶颈导致了这些国家教育发展缓慢。

英文主旨

This article refutes the conventional mainstream view that formal education should be the top priority for promoting rapid economic growth in poor countries, pointing out that the relationship between formal education and economic growth is widely misunderstood by both economists and politicians. Using examples of American auto workers and Mexican construction workers, it proves that on-the-job training can significantly boost labor productivity. It further puts forward the core argument that **economic growth actually drives educational development, not the other way around**; the lack of formal education does not constrain the ability of the workforce in developing countries to substantially improve productivity in the foreseeable future. Instead, constraints on productivity growth explain why education develops more slowly there.

二、逐句翻译+常考词汇+长难句分析

第一段

1. **原句**: The relationship between formal education and economic growth in poor countries is widely misunderstood by economists and politicians alike.

翻译: 正规教育与贫困国家经济增长之间的关系，被经济学家和政治家们普遍误解了。

常考单词/短语:

- formal education 正规教育
- economic growth 经济增长
- misunderstood (v.) 误解 (misunderstand的过去分词)
- alike (adv.) 两者都，同样地

2. **原句**: Progress in both areas is undoubtedly necessary for the social, political, and intellectual development of these and all other societies; however, the conventional view that education should be one of the very highest priorities for promoting rapid economic development in poor countries is wrong.

翻译: 毫无疑问，这两个领域的进步对于这些国家以及所有其他国家的社会、政治和智力发展都是必要的；然而，那种认为教育应成为贫困国家推动经济快速发展的最高优先事项之一的传统观点是错误的。

常考单词/短语:

- undoubtedly (adv.) 毫无疑问地
- intellectual (adj.) 智力的，知识的
- conventional (adj.) 传统的，惯例的
- priority (n.) 优先事项，优先权

- promote (v.) 促进, 推动

长难句分析:

本句是由分号连接的并列复合句。

- 分句1: 简单句, 主干为 *Progress is necessary*, *in both areas* 作定语修饰 *progress*, *for...societies* 作状语。
- 分句2: 主干为 *the conventional view is wrong*; *that education...poor countries* 是同一位语从句, 解释说明 *view* 的具体内容。

3. **原句:** We are fortunate that it is, because building new educational systems there and putting enough people through them to improve economic performance would require two or three generations.

翻译: 我们很庆幸这个观点是错的, 因为在这些国家建立新的教育体系, 并让足够多的人接受教育以提升经济表现, 需要两到三代人的时间。

常考单词/短语:

- fortunate (adj.) 幸运的
- educational system 教育体系
- put sb. through sth. 让某人完成某事 (尤指学业)
- economic performance 经济表现
- generation (n.) 一代人

长难句分析:

本句是复合句。

- 主句: *We are fortunate that it is*, *that it is* 是宾语从句, 指代上文“传统观点错误”这件事。
- 原因状语从句: *because...generations*, 从句的主语是两个并列的动名词短语 *building new educational systems there* 和 *putting enough people through them to improve economic performance*, 谓语是 *would require*。

4. **原句:** The findings of a research institution have consistently shown that workers in all countries can be trained on the job to achieve radically higher productivity and, as a result, radically higher standards of living.

翻译: 一家研究机构的研究结果始终表明, 所有国家的工人都可以通过在岗培训实现生产力的大幅提升, 并因此大幅提高生活水平。

常考单词/短语:

- finding (n.) 研究结果, 发现
- consistently (adv.) 一贯地, 始终如一地
- on the job 在岗, 在职
- radically (adv.) 根本地, 彻底地, 大幅地
- productivity (n.) 生产力, 生产率
- as a result 因此, 结果
- standard of living 生活水平

第二段

1. **原句:** Ironically, the first evidence for this idea appeared in the United States.

翻译: 具有讽刺意味的是, 这一观点的首个证据出现在美国。

常考单词/短语:

- ironically (adv.) 讽刺地, 说反话地
- evidence (n.) 证据, 证明

2. **原句:** Not long ago, with the country entering a recession and Japan at its pre-bubble peak, the U.S. workforce was derided as poorly educated and one of the primary causes of the poor U.S. economic performance.

翻译: 不久前, 当美国陷入经济衰退、日本处于泡沫破裂前的顶峰时, 美国的劳动力被嘲笑为受教育

育程度低，并且被认为是美国经济表现不佳的主要原因之一。

常考单词/短语：

- recession (n.) 经济衰退，不景气
- pre-bubble (adj.) 泡沫前的
- peak (n.) 顶峰，巅峰
- workforce (n.) 劳动力，全体员工
- deride (v.) 嘲笑，嘲弄
- primary (adj.) 主要的，首要的

3. **原句：** Japan was, and remains, the global leader in automotive-assembly productivity.

翻译： 日本过去是，现在仍然是全球汽车装配生产力的领导者。

常考单词/短语：

- remain (v.) 仍然是，保持
- automotive-assembly (n.) 汽车装配

4. **原句：** Yet the research revealed that the U.S. factories of Honda, Nissan, and Toyota achieved about 95 percent of the productivity of their Japanese counterparts – a result of the training that U.S. workers received on the job.

翻译： 然而研究显示，本田、日产和丰田在美国的工厂达到了其日本本土工厂约95%的生产力——这是美国工人接受在岗培训的结果。

常考单词/短语：

- reveal (v.) 显示，揭示
- counterpart (n.) 对应的人或物，同行

长难句分析：

本句是复合句。

- 主句： *the research revealed that...* , **that** 引导宾语从句。
- 破折号后： **a result of...** 是同位语，解释说明前面宾语从句的内容；其中 **that U.S. workers received on the job** 是定语从句，修饰training。

第三段

1. **原句：** More recently, while examining housing construction, the researchers discovered that illiterate, non-English-speaking Mexican workers in Houston, Texas, consistently met best-practice labor productivity standards despite the complexity of the building industry's work.

翻译： 最近，研究人员在考察住房建筑业时发现，尽管建筑业的工作很复杂，但得克萨斯州休斯顿市那些不识字、不会说英语的墨西哥工人却始终能达到最佳的劳动生产率标准。

常考单词/短语：

- housing construction 住房建筑业
- illiterate (adj.) 不识字的，文盲的
- best-practice (adj.) 最佳实践的
- labor productivity 劳动生产率
- despite (prep.) 尽管，不管
- complexity (n.) 复杂性，复杂程度

第四段

1. **原句：** What is the real relationship between education and economic development?

翻译： 教育与经济发展之间真正的关系是什么？

2. **原句:** We have to suspect that continuing economic growth promotes the development of education even when governments don't force it.

翻译: 我们不得不怀疑, 即使政府不强制推行教育, 持续的经济增长也会促进教育的发展。

常考单词/短语:

- suspect (v.) 怀疑, 猜想
- force (v.) 强迫, 迫使

3. **原句:** After all, that's how education got started.

翻译: 毕竟, 教育最初就是这样开始的。

常考单词/短语:

- after all 毕竟, 终究

4. **原句:** When our ancestors were hunters and gatherers 10,000 years ago, they didn't have time to wonder much about anything besides finding food.

翻译: 一万年前, 当我们的祖先还是狩猎采集者时, 他们除了寻找食物, 没有时间去思考其他任何事情。

常考单词/短语:

- ancestor (n.) 祖先
- hunter and gatherer 狩猎采集者
- wonder about 思考, 琢磨

5. **原句:** Only when humanity began to get its food in a more productive way was there time for other things.

翻译: 只有当人类开始以更高效的方式获取食物时, 才有时间去做其他事情。

长难句分析:

本句是倒装句。only+状语从句 置于句首时, 主句需要部分倒装, 正常语序为: *There was time for other things only when humanity began to get its food in a more productive way.*

第五段

1. **原句:** As education improved, humanity's productivity potential increased as well.

翻译: 随着教育的进步, 人类的生产力潜力也随之提高。

常考单词/短语:

- potential (n.) 潜力, 潜能
- as well 也, 同样

2. **原句:** When the competitive environment pushed our ancestors to achieve that potential, they could in turn afford more education.

翻译: 当竞争环境促使我们的祖先去实现这种潜力时, 他们反过来又能负担得起更多的教育。

常考单词/短语:

- competitive (adj.) 竞争的
- in turn 反过来, 依次
- afford (v.) 负担得起, 买得起

3. **原句:** This increasingly high level of education is probably a necessary, but not a sufficient, condition for the complex political systems required by advanced economic performance.

翻译: 这种日益提高的教育水平, 对于发达经济所要求的复杂政治体系来说, 可能是一个必要但不充分的条件。

常考单词/短语:

- necessary (adj.) 必要的, 必需的
- sufficient (adj.) 足够的, 充分的
- complex (adj.) 复杂的
- advanced (adj.) 先进的, 发达的

4. **原句**: Thus poor countries might not be able to escape their poverty traps without political changes that may be possible only with broader formal education.

翻译: 因此, 如果没有政治变革, 贫困国家可能无法摆脱其贫困陷阱, 而这种政治变革或许只有通过更广泛的正规教育才能实现。

常考单词/短语:

- thus (adv.) 因此, 从而
- escape (v.) 逃脱, 摆脱
- poverty trap 贫困陷阱
- broader (adj.) 更广泛的

5. **原句**: A lack of formal education, however, doesn't constrain the ability of the developing world's workforce to substantially improve productivity for the foreseeable future.

翻译: 然而, 缺乏正规教育并不会限制发展中国家的劳动力在可预见的未来大幅提升生产力的能力。

常考单词/短语:

- a lack of 缺乏
- constrain (v.) 限制, 约束
- substantially (adv.) 大幅地, 实质上
- foreseeable (adj.) 可预见的
- in the foreseeable future 在可预见的未来

6. **原句**: On the contrary, constraints on improving productivity explain why education isn't developing more quickly there than it is.

翻译: 相反, 正是生产力提升的限制, 解释了为什么那里的教育没有发展得更快。

常考单词/短语:

- on the contrary 相反

三、完整原文

① The relationship between formal education and economic growth in poor countries is widely misunderstood by economists and politicians alike. Progress in both areas is undoubtedly necessary for the social, political, and intellectual development of these and all other societies; however, the conventional view that education should be one of the very highest priorities for promoting rapid economic development in poor countries is wrong. We are fortunate that it is, because building new educational systems there and putting enough people through them to improve economic performance would require two or three generations. The findings of a research institution have consistently shown that workers in all countries can be trained on the job to achieve radically higher productivity and, as a result, radically higher standards of living.

② Ironically, the first evidence for this idea appeared in the United States. Not long ago, with the country entering a recession and Japan at its pre-bubble peak, the U.S. workforce was derided as poorly educated and one of the primary causes of the poor U.S. economic performance. Japan was, and remains, the global leader in automotive-assembly productivity. Yet the research revealed that the U.S. factories of Honda, Nissan, and Toyota achieved about 95 percent of the productivity of their Japanese counterparts – a result of the training that U.S. workers received on the job.

③ More recently, while examining housing construction, the researchers discovered that illiterate, non-English-speaking Mexican workers in Houston, Texas, consistently met best-practice labor productivity standards despite the complexity of the building industry's work.

④ What is the real relationship between education and economic development? We have to suspect that continuing economic growth promotes the development of education even when governments don't force it. After all, that's how education got started. When our ancestors were hunters and gatherers 10,000 years ago, they didn't have time to wonder much about anything besides finding food. Only when humanity began to get its food in a more productive way was there time for other things.

⑤ As education improved, humanity's productivity potential increased as well. When the competitive environment pushed our ancestors to achieve that potential, they could in turn afford more education. This increasingly high level of education is probably a necessary, but not a sufficient, condition for the complex political systems required by advanced economic performance. Thus poor countries might not be able to escape their poverty traps without political changes that may be possible only with broader formal education. A lack of formal education, however, doesn't constrain the ability of the developing world's workforce to substantially improve productivity for the foreseeable future. On the contrary, constraints on improving productivity explain why education isn't developing more quickly there than it is.

四、完整全文翻译

① 正规教育与贫困国家经济增长之间的关系，被经济学家和政治家们普遍误解了。毫无疑问，这两个领域的进步对于这些国家以及所有其他国家的社会、政治和智力发展都是必要的；然而，那种认为教育应成为贫困国家推动经济快速发展的最高优先事项之一的传统观点是错误的。我们很庆幸这个观点是错误的，因为在这些国家建立新的教育体系，并让足够多的人接受教育以提升经济表现，需要两到三代人的时间。一家研究机构的研究结果始终表明，所有国家的工人都可以通过在岗培训实现生产力的大幅提升，并因此大幅提高生活水平。

② 具有讽刺意味的是，这一观点的首个证据出现在美国。不久前，当美国陷入经济衰退、日本处于泡沫破裂前的顶峰时，美国的劳动力被嘲笑为受教育程度低，并且被认为是美国经济表现不佳的主要原因之一。日本过去是，现在仍然是全球汽车装配生产力的领导者。然而研究显示，本田、日产和丰田在美国的工厂达到了其日本本土工厂约95%的生产力——这是美国工人接受在岗培训的结果。

③ 最近，研究人员在考察住房建筑业时发现，尽管建筑业的工作很复杂，但得克萨斯州休斯顿市那些不识字、不会说英语的墨西哥工人却始终能达到最佳的劳动生产率标准。

④ 教育与经济发展之间真正的关系是什么？我们不得不怀疑，即使政府不强制推行教育，持续的经济增长也会促进教育的发展。毕竟，教育最初就是这样开始的。一万年前的祖先还是狩猎采集者时，他们除了寻找食物，没有时间去思考其他任何事情。只有当人类开始以更高效的方式获取食物时，才有时间去做其他事情。

⑤ 随着教育的进步，人类的生产力潜力也随之提高。当竞争环境促使我们的祖先去实现这种潜力时，他们反过来又能负担得起更多的教育。这种日益提高的教育水平，对于发达经济所要求的复杂政治体系来说，可能是一个必要但不充分的条件。因此，如果没有政治变革，贫困国家可能无法摆脱其贫困陷阱，而这种政治变革或许只有通过更广泛的正规教育才能实现。然而，缺乏正规教育并不会限制发展中国家的劳动力在可预见的未来大幅提升生产力的能力。相反，正是生产力提升的限制，解释了为什么那里的教育没有发展得更快。